that Obama featured in the first *Mann ki Baat* radio show of 2015 alongside Modi.

Whether you believe in Narendra Modi or firmly oppose his politics, the point is that he represents a new epoch in Indian politics. No prime minister since Nehru has embodied so much political power. Modi has not only led his party to two successive victories at the national level, he also presided over its replacing of the Congress as India's predominant national party, ushering in a new era of party politics.

The Congress under Nehru and Indira dominated Indian politics for decades due to what was called the 'Congress system', to quote Rajni Kothari's elegant phrasing.[40] The BJP, committed to ushering in a 'Congress-mukt Bharat', Congress-free India, has filled the vacuum created by the decline of the Congress with its own BJP system. The how and why of that is the story this book tells.